becoming dependent on it."

Research remains another defining pillar of the AIIMS experience. Earlier this year, it climbed in the QS Global Rankings, a reflection not only of its clinical excellence but also of the growing international recognition of its scientific output and research impact. Students are encouraged to participate in research from an early stage, across areas ranging from clinical studies and translational medicine to public health and biomedical innovation, helping bridge the gap between scientific discovery and patient care. Equally important is the institute's focus on community medicine. Students are exposed not only to the realities of tertiary healthcare but also to the social, economic and environmental factors that shape health outcomes. "India's healthcare challenges cannot be understood only from within hospital walls," says Dr Tandon. "Community medicine teaches future doctors to understand the realities in which patients live."

For prospective students, Dr Tandon has an important message. "Medicine should never be chosen simply because it is prestigious or secure," he says. "It is a demanding profession that requires commitment, resilience and genuine interest. If the passion is absent, the pressures can become overwhelming. But for those who truly want to serve, there are very few careers that offer greater meaning." It is a philosophy that continues to draw some of the brightest young minds in the country to AIIMS. ■

STUDENTSPEAK

"AIIMS offers unmatched clinical exposure, with rare and complex cases that sharpen clinical thinking, decision-making under pressure and confidence, helping students grow into capable doctors prepared for real-world medical challenges"

DHRUV ADVANI, ***MBBS, Third year***



TOP 10 GOVERNMENT COLLEGES WITH LOWEST FEES MEDICAL

RANK	COLLEGE	CITY	COURSE FEE* (ENTIRE DURATION)
1	ARMED FORCES MEDICAL COLLEGE (AFMC)	Pune	₹0
2	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS) NEW DELHI	New Delhi	₹1,628
3	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS) JODHPUR	Jodhpur	₹3,366
4	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS) RAIPUR	Raipur	₹4,256
5	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS) NAGPUR	Nagpur	₹5,356
6	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS) BHUBANESWAR	Bhubaneswar	₹5,856
6	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS) BHOPAL	Bhopal	₹5,856
6	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS) PATNA	Patna	₹5,856
9	MAULANA AZAD MEDICAL COLLEGE (MAMC)	New Delhi	₹11,660
10	ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS) RISHIKESH	Rishikesh	₹19,950

**Course fee = Tuition fee + other fees; AFMC does not charge any fees*